

4. A Dozen Miskito Birthdays (20 marks)

Problem designed by Shinjini Ghosh

Sumu has 12 friends; let's denote them by the letters from A to L. One day Sumu's friends decided to play a prank on her. They swapped their names, photographs and all other information on their Facebook profiles randomly among themselves. Sumu had no way to recognize who was who. However, her friends did not change one information – their birthdays. It was a clue that Sumu could use to identify her friends, if she remembered all of their birthdays. Fortunately, Sumu did remember her friends' birthdays. But to her surprise, her friends had listed their birthdays not in English, but in an unknown language called *Miskito*. Sumu listed down the birthdays of her 12 friends, A to L, and the Miskito dates mentioned in her friends profiles (in random order):

Dates in English

- A. 10th December
- B. 6th March
- C. 2nd October
- D. 11th February
- E. 7th May
- F. 12th September
- G. 3rd January
- H. 9th August
- I. 8th November
- J. 5th July
- K. 4th April
- L. 1st June

Miskito Dates

- 1. Matawalsip pura kumi, Kuswa Kati
- 2. Yumhpa, Siakwa Kati
- 3. Matawalsip pura wal, Wis Kati
- 4. Matlal kahbi pura wal, Yahbra Kati
- 5. Matlal kahbi, Kakamuk Kati
- 6. Walwal, Lih wainhka Kati
- 7. Wal, Waupasa Kati
- 8. Matawalsip, Trisu Kati
- 9. Matlal kahbi pura yumhpa, Sikla Kati
- 10. Kumi, Li Kati
- 11. Matlal kahbi pura kumi, Lih Mairin Kati
- 12. Matsip, Pastara Kati

Can you help Sumu to find out who is who by matching the Miskito dates to the English ones?

Assignment 1 [Answer-Booklet]: Match the Miskito dates with their English translations.

Assignment 2 [Answer-Booklet]: What do you think 'Kati' means literally?

Assignment 3 [Answer Booklet]: Sumu then decides to write her teachers' birthdays in Miskito. Help her to write the following dates in Miskito:

- (a) 6th July, (b) 9th April, (c) 10th January, (d) 5th May, (e) 7th September

Note: Miskito is spoken by the Miskito people who live in Northeastern Nicaragua. There are approximately 150000 Miskito speakers.
